

businesses don't. But if your business isn't making money after 36 months, it's not a business; at best, it's a hobby, at worst a money pit. Three years: that's all the time you're allowed to get it right.

Money Mistake: *You Aren't Willing to Make Sacrifices*

The Fix: *Don't Start a Family Business*

Since the opening of their second location at Faneuil Hall, Tracey and Dani have had to make some adjustments. They are still learning how much product to order if they want to fill all their orders with no excess and no shortfall. If they order too many, the cupcakes go to waste and they lose money. If they order too few, they can't fill all their orders and risk making their customers unhappy. "It's like walking a tightrope," Tracey says. "We're right one week, then the next week we'll order too much."

Like learning anything new, sometimes they make mistakes. "Last week, my husband went in on Sunday to pick up the receipts. When he looked at them, he realized we weren't going to make it to Monday/Tuesday, because we hadn't baked enough cupcakes. It was Sunday, our one day off, but we had to suck it up, go into the shop and bake."

"That's the way it has to be," says Tracey. "Everybody has to be all in." Dani agrees. "Everyone has to be a team player. You can't say, 'It's five o'clock, I did what I needed to do, I'm leaving,' when there's three more hours of baking to do. You've got to give it 110 percent."

Dani has given up a great deal for Wicked Good Cupcakes, too. "I've sacrificed a lot of stuff that other young adults do." Dani doesn't see her friends as much as she'd like because she works a lot, but she is building her very own financial dynasty at an early age, and that's going to pay off big-time in the future. And I helped teach her how.

"We wouldn't be where we are today without Kevin's help. I want him to be proud of Mom and me. I want to keep making him money!"